- The presentations, particularly the review of the operational situation and the progress of our operations in the MO operations room, were my responsibility as the ADGMO. I was present during all discussions on the progress of operations. We were told that we should take care not to cross the LoC, and keep the conflict localized; further, diplomatic and other pressure would be put on Pakistan to vacate. The employment of the air force was approved by the CCS on 25 May 1999, albeit on our side of the LoC only. During the course of the war there were four or five occasions when this high-powered body met to review the progress of operations. In one meeting towards the end of June, when the tide had definitely turned in our favour, a question was posed, 'What if the Pakistanis agree to withdraw?' Since no one responded, I got up and suggested that we should continue our operations till we finish the assigned task. When asked as to how long that would take, I responded that it could take a few weeks more. Then there was some discussion on the number of casualties that might occur and so on. Such interactions ensured that well-considered decisions were taken by our political and military hierarchy after a deliberate analysis. This did not seem to be the case as far as Pakistan was concerned, in view of the hush-hush manner in which the Kargil war was prosecuted. Shireen Mazari hit the nail on the head when she articulated that, 'Essentially, the advantage Pakistan gained at the tactical level was lost at the strategic level – especially the initiative, primarily for lack of an institutionalized national response.'[13]
- At first the Indian Army did not make much headway as it tried to mount assaults along the spurs. These approaches were well defended. It was my suggestion to move trained mountaineers from the high-altitude warfare school in Gulmarg to each infantry battalion along with soldiers from Ladakh Scouts. This gave our troops the capability of attacking the formidable 'sangar' (a defensive position made by heaping stones and rocks) from the steep flanks or the rear by using mountaineering skills and rock-climbing techniques. The attack on Tiger Hill in this manner